

Preston Carey Leslie

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Store Operations Transformation Selection Team
Nordstrom, Inc.
1617 6th Ave, Seattle, WA 98101

RE: Process & Insights Engineer – Store Operations (Job ID: Store Operations Transformation)

Dear Nordstrom Selection Team:

I am writing to express my interest in the Process & Insights Engineer position within Store Operations. As an operations translator completing my Master of Science in Quantitative Methods and Modeling at Baruch College, I specialize in the exact space where rigid data architecture meets messy, real-world frontline execution. I am actively planning to relocate to the Pacific Northwest and am eager to bring my hybrid toolkit to Nordstrom's Seattle headquarters.

Nordstrom's focus on grounding data in the reality of frontline store workflows perfectly mirrors my professional philosophy. I believe that operational truth lives with the frontline teams who directly define the customer experience, and I do not engineer solutions from an isolated silo. Throughout my career in complex healthcare environments and high-volume hospitality logistics, I have built a reputation for working directly alongside floor personnel to diagnose why systems break, ensuring that analytical frameworks prioritize the dignity and efficiency of the people executing the work.

Furthermore, I understand the pressure of managing high-concurrency environments where system logic must align with rapid manual execution. Managing real-time resource routing and workflow logistics for 11 concurrent nodes during peak operational demand taught me how to isolate capacity constraints under intense stress. When evaluating messy operational data, I am able to trace an issue end-to-end, pressure-test the data against what is actually happening on the ground, and identify actionable solutions to reduce operational variability.

My quantitative coursework at Zicklin, specifically in Simulation Modelling & Analysis and my Quantitative Modelling courses, provide me with the mathematical frameworks required to model fulfillment flows and size operational tradeoffs. Combined with my technical capability in SQL, Python, Tableau, and Google Data (formerly Looker) Studio, I am highly equipped to automate reporting pipelines and build clear scenario analyses. Crucially, my background in graphic design allows me to translate these complex statistical findings into highly intuitive, visual data stories that technical developers and frontline store teams can immediately understand and act upon.

I bring the rigorous analytical mind of a quantitative modeler backed by fifteen years of real-world operational grit. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background as a cross-functional translator can support Nordstrom's multi-year store fulfillment transformation. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Preston Carey Leslie